The Carbon Cycle

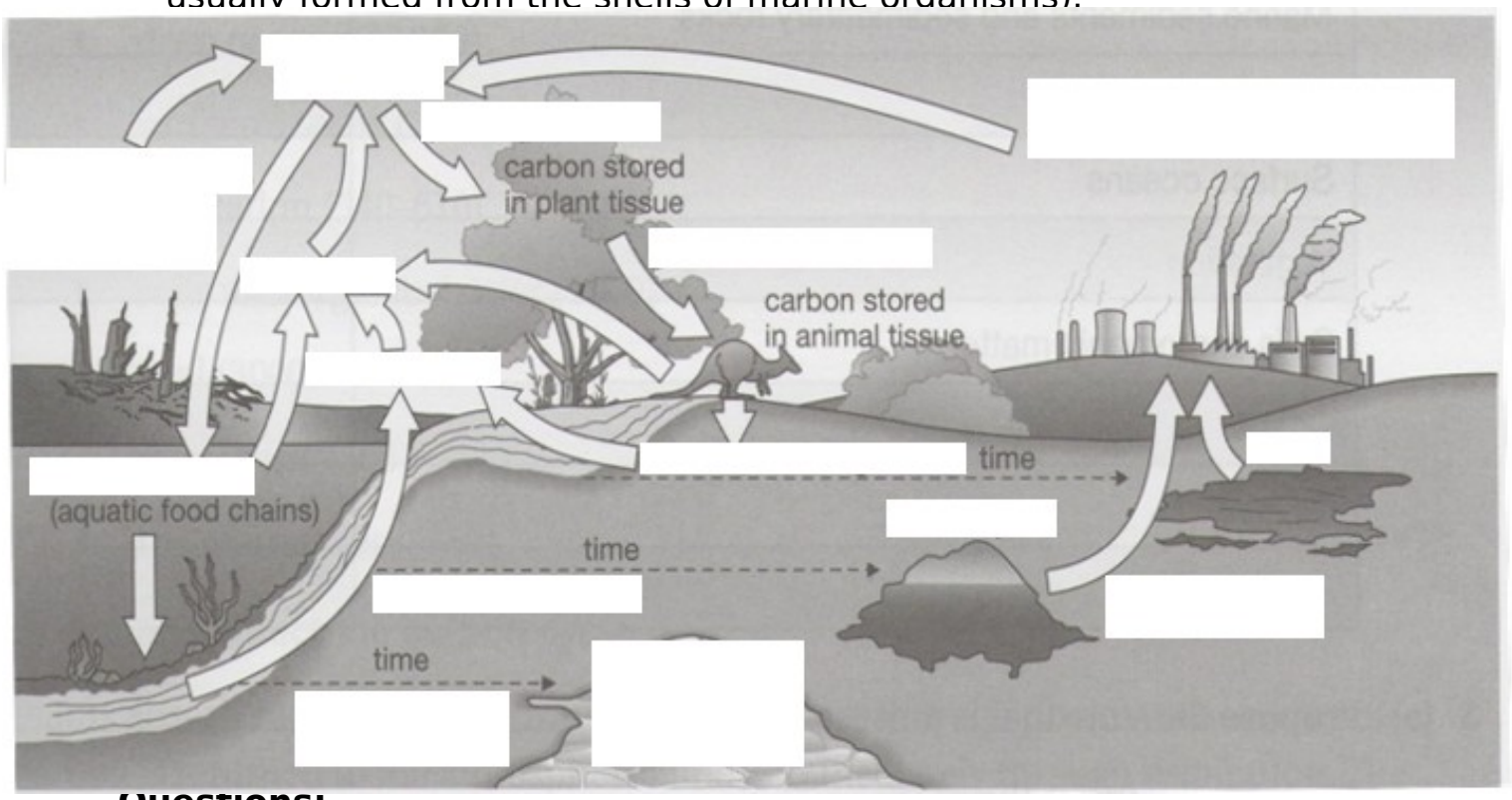
Why is carbon important?

- Carbon is the element which forms _____.
- Carbon can form long chain molecules, which include _____ _____ .
- Carbon is a _____.

The Carbon Cycle

- Plants take in _____ because they need the carbon and oxygen to use in _____.
- Through _____ plants make _____.
- When animals eat plants, they use some of the carbon containing compounds for _____.
- Some carbon containing compounds are used by organisms to _____ through the process of _____.
- Carbon is released into the _____ in the _____ of organisms, for example _____, _____ and _____.
- These wastes are used as _____ by _____.
- Fossils are the _____ of organisms.
- Coal and oil are _____, which contain the carbon of organisms that were preserved millions of years ago.
- Burning fossil fuels releases carbon that has been unavailable to the carbon cycle for millions of years.

- Burning _____ releases carbon stored for _____.
- The earth's _____ store of carbon is the _____ found in _____ (a rock usually formed from the shells of marine organisms).



Questions:

1. Name the process that takes carbon into food chains.
2. Carbon is a major part of living things. Explain how the carbon gets into living things.

3. Explain what the carbon is used for in the bodies of living things.

4. Explain how decomposers return carbon to the atmosphere.

5. Explain where the carbon in coal and oil came from.

6. What is meant by the phrase *long-term stores* in relation to the carbon cycle?

7. Name two stores of carbon.